Yes, you are right. A two-hour lunch should **not** feel like a technical diligence meeting. Use work as a base, but mostly make it a human conversation with intelligent pivots.

Best strategy: **70% normal conversation, 20% career/firm, 10% technical ILS**.

Start light:
“Thanks for taking the time. I’ve been looking forward to this because your path from reinsurance to Quantedge is pretty unusual.”

Then let conversation breathe.

Good topics:

Career path
“What made you move from reinsurance into investing?”
“Did the hedge fund world feel very different from underwriting?”
“At what point did you realise ILS could fit inside a systematic portfolio?”

Judgement and taste
“When you were junior, what made someone stand out?”
“What kind of mistakes do smart junior people make?”
“What do you think is underrated in this business?”

Quantedge culture
“What has kept you at Quantedge for so long?”
“How has the firm changed since you joined?”
“What kind of people tend to do well here?”

Personal but safe
“How did you find the move to Singapore/New York/finance from a physics-actuarial background?”
“Do you still think like a physicist, actuary, or investor?”
“What do you enjoy outside work when things are not too busy?”

ILS, but conversational
“The part I find most interesting is that ILS looks actuarial on paper but becomes an investment problem once you consider sizing, liquidity, and model risk.”
“Do you think good ILS investing is more about modelling the risk correctly, or knowing where the model is wrong?”

Avoid sounding like you prepared a questionnaire. Pick **5 questions max**. The rest should be follow-ups.

Best thing to do before lunch:
Prepare a **30-second explanation** of what you are working on.
Prepare **one honest observation** from the internship so far.
Prepare **one non-obvious question** about his career.
Prepare **one question about what good looks like for interns**.

Example:
“One thing I’m trying to understand is how to turn model output into an actual investment decision. The

model gives expected loss, return period, spread, etc., but the real judgement seems to be in sizing and deciding whether the uncertainty is acceptable."

That will land better than generic finance questions.

Memorise **8**, use **4–6 max**.

1. "What made you leave the reinsurance/actuarial side and move into investing?"
2. "What did you have to unlearn when moving from underwriting to hedge fund investing?"
3. "What has kept you at Quantedge for so long?"
4. "What kind of junior people actually become useful quickly here?"
5. "What mistakes do smart interns or junior researchers usually make?"
6. "In ILS, where do you think the biggest gap is between model output and real investment judgement?"
7. "When looking at a cat bond or reinsurance risk, what usually matters more: pricing, sizing, or knowing when not to trade?"
8. "How do you think about model risk when the most important events are exactly the ones with the least data?"

Optional lighter ones if the conversation opens naturally:

9. "Do you still think more like a physicist, actuary, or investor?"
10. "What parts of the job are still genuinely interesting to you after doing this for years?"
11. "What do people misunderstand about ILS from the outside?"
12. "Outside work, what do you usually do in Singapore when you actually have free time?"

Best single question:

"From your experience, what separates someone who is technically strong from someone who is actually useful in an investment team?"